

OXFORD

INTERNATIONAL
AQA EXAMINATIONS

INTERNATIONAL A-LEVEL ENGLISH LITERATURE

Mark scheme

LT03

Unit 3 Elements of crime and mystery

Version 1.0 Specimen

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Assessment Writer.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

Information for Examiners

This mark scheme is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 6–8. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The assessment objectives and their significance

12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally-weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 18 years old so we are judging their skills at the end of Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	- perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task - assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	- perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task - assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task - assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	- thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task - coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	- thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task - thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth - appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘ Straightforward ’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘ Relevant ’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	- straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task - relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly . At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	- straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task - relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task - some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘ Simple ’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘ Generalised ’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	- simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task - generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	- simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task - generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- a simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task - generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate , and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant .
	AO2	the writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

William Shakespeare: *Macbeth*

‘Macbeth is a natural-born killer.’

Discuss Shakespeare’s presentation of Macbeth in the light of this statement.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Macbeth* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Macbeth’s slaying of Duncan
- Macbeth’s brutal actions in the war which although state-endorsed seem unnecessarily violent
- Macbeth’s hiring of the three murderers to kill Banquo and Fleance which suggests his growing confidence and feelings of impunity
- Macbeth’s decision to kill Macduff’s family
- an alternative view might be that Lady Macbeth is presented as having initially taunted her husband into action
- Shakespeare’s presentation of the witches as having corrupted Macbeth which leads to his killing of Duncan
- Macbeth’s initial discomfort at the idea of killing Duncan and his statement that they ‘will proceed no further in this business.’

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the play opening with details of the gruesome and barbaric behaviour of Macbeth while at war
- the dramatic method which sees Macbeth on stage holding two daggers and with bloodstained hands
- Lady Macbeth’s claim that Macbeth is ‘too full o’ th’ milk of human kindness’ and Shakespeare’s presentation of her cold determination as a contrast to his indecision
- Banquo’s ghost which could be seen as a symbol of Macbeth’s guilt
- Macbeth’s inability to pray which happens immediately after his killing of Duncan, suggesting it is a direct result of his guilt and paranoia at his actions
- Macbeth’s discomfort in his actions which is symbolised in the imagery of his mind ‘full of scorpions’.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the subjects of Shakespeare's play
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of dramatic method, any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which are grounded in the question and which relate to the play as a whole.

0 2

Samuel Taylor Coleridge: *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner**The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* is essentially a moral tale.

How far do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* through the lens of **crime and mystery** the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the fact that the central crime is a transgression against nature and universal order (perhaps with reference to the one life principal)
- the moral consequences of the Mariner's crime – his inability to pray
- the Mariner and the Wedding Guest who both learn a moral lesson
- The Mariner's desire to see the Hermit, so as to 'wash away the Albatross's blood'
- An alternative view might consider that *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* is more a fantastical exploration of the imagination
- The possibility that the poem is more ecological than moral in purpose.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the Mariner's extended dialogue which acts as a form of confession and warning against crime and immorality
- the remote setting of the Mariner's story which could be representative of the mariners breaking God's and nature's boundaries
- the setting of the church for the frame narrative
- an allegorical reading which sees the albatross as symbolic of Christ
- the repeated religious imagery and language throughout
- the inclusion of an explicit moral at the end of the mariner's tale 'He prayeth best who loveth best, all things great and small.'

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the subjects of Coleridge's poetry

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- organisation of ideas
 - use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
 - technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction methods, any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the text as a whole.

0 3

Robert Browning: *Selected Poems*

‘The resolutions of Robert Browning’s poetry tell us that crime does pay.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

In your answer you should make reference to ‘The Laboratory’ and **at least one other poem**.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied Browning’s *Selected Poems* through the lens of **crime and mystery** the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the speaker in ‘The Laboratory’ whom Browning depicts manufacturing her murder weapon but who ends the poem planning to ‘dance at the king’s’
- the suggestion that as a result of the speaker poisoning her rivals, she will successfully achieve her criminal aim
- the resolution of ‘Porphyria’s Lover’ where the narrator expresses delight in how well his criminal act has turned out for him
- an alternative interpretation could be that the ambiguity of the resolution in ‘The Laboratory’ means that we do not know if her crime pays off
- Porphyria, whose social crime (the implied rejection of her class and her unauthorised visit to her lover) results in her death
- the Mayor in ‘The Pied Piper of Hamelin’ whose decision not pay the Piper results in the stealing of the town’s children
- The Patriot whose year’s misdeeds result in his death.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the exclamatory, jubilant tone at the end of ‘The Laboratory’
- the use of the future tense which means that the success or otherwise of her crime is unknown
- the use of the immediate retrospective in ‘Porphyria’s Lover’ which allows the narrator to recount his crime whilst sitting by Porphyria’s body
- the use of pathetic fallacy and setting to present foreboding around Porphyria’s abandoning of her feast in order to see her lover
- the resolution of ‘The Pied Piper of Hamelin’ which is a moral warning against the crime of breaking promises

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- the ambiguity of the Patriot's 'crimes' in 'The Patriot' which means that a possible reading could be that the Patriot is not guilty of a crime and it is the townsfolk who are the criminals.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the subjects of Browning's poetry
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction methods, any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the text as a whole.

0 4

Charles Dickens: *Oliver Twist*

In *Oliver Twist* Dickens presents violence against others as the most unforgivable of crimes.

To what extent do you agree with this view of the novel?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied *Oliver Twist* through the lens of **crime and mystery** the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the horror of the many acts of violence in the novel, culminating in the brutal murder of Nancy,
- the violence against Oliver and the other workhouse boys from those paid to protect them
- Sikes who suffers mental torment and death as a result of his murder of Nancy
- the somewhat affectionate characterisation of some of the criminals such as Nancy and Dodger whose crimes are seen as forgivable by the narrator
- the fact that those who are guilty of violence are punished in the novel, if not by death then by enduring misery or humiliation as in the case of Bumble
- an alternative view might be that Fagin’s abuse of the boys is through manipulation and threat rather than physical violence but is still seen as unforgivable
- That it is Noah Claypole’s abuse of his mother rather than his violent treatment of her which Oliver finds most unforgivable.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the resolution which sees Fagin facing capital punishment despite his abuse not being of the violent kind
- the language use to describe Oliver and the workhouse boys as small and victimised in contrast to the sturdy characters such as Mr Bumble and Mrs Sowerberry
- the graphic details of Nancy’s physical injuries and the ‘heavy’ murder weapon which serve to present the violence against her as unforgivable
- the sustained threats of violence against Oliver such as ‘I’ll strew your brains upon the grass’
- the use of the omniscient narrative perspective with the almost casual references to beatings as if violence is the norm, particularly for Oliver
- the characterisation of Nancy, Dodger and Charley Bates which is empathetic
- the contrasting brutality of the presentation of those characters who use violence, including the ugliness of their physical appearance, Sikes in particular.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the subjects of Dickens' novel,
- organisation of ideas,
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question,
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction methods, any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the text as a whole.

0 5

Edgar Allen Poe: *Collected Stories*

To what extent do you agree that the crimes in Poe's short stories are acts of inexplicable violence?

In your answer you should make reference to 'The Black Cat' and **at least one other story**.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied Poe's *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery** the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the initial maiming of Pluto, which is unprovoked and deliberate
- the murder of the narrator's wife who is described as 'uncomplaining' and as a 'patient sufferer' and who is brutally murdered without real motive
- the narrator's motive for violent murder in 'The Tell-Tale Heart' which is insubstantial in that he is unnerved by his victim's eye
- the criminal in 'The Murders of the Rue Morgue' who is not human and acts violently out of animal instinct alone
- an alternative argument could be that the narrator of 'The Black Cat' hints at drunkenness as the explanation for the initial violence against Pluto
- the crime in 'The Purloined Letter' which is neither violent nor inexplicable.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of the first person, retrospective narrative in 'The Black Cat' which describes the act of removing Pluto's eye as an 'atrocious' act
- the graphic language used to describe the violence of the narrator's wife's murder and the suddenness of the act
- the use of the first-person narrative which explicitly admits love for his victim in 'The Tell-Tale Heart'
- the direct address in 'The Tell-Tale Heart', which is an attempt to convince the reader that the narrator's violence is not an act of madness
- the inclusion of the reportage from the Gazette des Tribunaux in 'The Murders in the Rue Morgue' which focuses on the 'extraordinary' nature of the violent crimes
- the use of political and diplomatic language to describe the nature of the crime and the letter in 'The Purloined Letter'.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the subjects of Poe's stories
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the texts as a whole.

0 6

Robert Louis Stevenson: *Collected Stories*

‘Stevenson’s crime writing explores the idea that criminal savagery is ever present within polite society.’

Discuss this view of Stevenson’s stories with reference to ‘Jekyll and Hyde’ and **at least one other story**.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied Stevenson’s *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery** the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Dr Jekyll who has lived a life of ‘effort, virtue and control’ from which he desires an escape
- Hyde’s unrepentant brutality and savagery, seen in the trampling of the child
- Wolfe Macfarlane who is a respectable figure but who is complicit in criminal behavior
- the linked lives of the educated figures of Fettes and Macfarlane with the savage criminals such as Gray
- the ‘thievish crew’ in ‘A Lodging for the Night’ who are drinking and gambling but who include a priest, a monk and a self-proclaimed ‘master of the arts’
- the possible interpretation that the Lord of Brisetout and the Chaplain of Benoit’s treatment of Villon could be seen as criminal and/or savage
- an alternative interpretation might be the shock and horror with which Hyde’s crimes are received by Utterson and Lanyon which suggests they are unusual.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial method

Focus might be on:

- the use of Victorian Britain as a setting with its colonial ideas about civility and savagery
- the use of Hyde as a symbol for the hidden savagery that is present in polite society
- physical descriptions of Hyde which focus on the ugliness and brutality of his appearance, and which contrast with the genteel depiction of Dr Jekyll who could ‘laugh at suspicion’
- the use of the frame narrative setting in ‘The Body Snatcher’ which offers an outsider’s perspective on Macfarlane as a distinct figure of polite society
- the use of the Latin phrase ‘quid pro quo’ by Mr K to describe the criminal understanding that exists between the doctors and ‘the trade’
- the urban, night-time settings as backdrops for savage criminal behaviour
- the opening on drinking, gambling and a savage murder in ‘A Lodging for the Night’.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the subjects of Stevenson's stories
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction methods, any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which relate to the text as a whole.

0 7

Agatha Christie: *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd*

‘Hercule Poirot is indeed the ‘super-detective’ that Dr Sheppard describes him as.’

How far do you agree with the view that Christie presents Poirot as having an almost supernatural investigative ability?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Poirot’s ability to see things that others don’t, such as the scrap of cambric and the ring in the goldfish pond
- Poirot’s solving of the seemingly impossible locked room mystery
- Poirot’s succeeding where the police detectives are completely unable to
- Poirot’s recognition that Ralph is innocent despite the overwhelming evidence to the contrary
- Poirot’s assertion that clues such as chairs and tables ‘speak to’ him sometimes
- an alternative view might be that Christie employs Poirot as a figure of ridicule
- the opening which presents Poirot as a ‘retired hairdresser’ who ‘grows marrows.’

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the omnipotence of Poirot shown through the repetition and italicisation of ‘Poirot, he *knows*’
- the imagery of Poirot’s eyes as having a ‘queer green glow’
- the use of the self-reflexive humour that mocks Poirot’s involvement with sensational cases such as the case of the Russian Grand Duchess
- Christie’s language choices which present Poirot’s abilities as superlative and as holding a type of ‘spell’ over the suspects
- the repetition of ‘the little grey cells’ which seems to normalise Poirot’s ability
- the use of Sheppard’s perspective to present Poirot as self-important and ridiculous
- the use of Sheppard’s retrospective perspective which recognises that Poirot was always several steps ahead of him.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the subjects of Christie's novel
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction methods, any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which are grounded in the question and which relate to the novel as a whole.

08

Qiu Xialong: *Death of a Red Heroine*

‘The opening murder in *Death of a Red Heroine* sets the tone for a novel in which every character is corrupt.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Death of a Red Heroine* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the discovery of Guan Hingyin's body which is naked and corrupted by water
- Guan Hongyin who is the revered red heroine of the title but who is exploited and coerced into pornographic photographs and a corrupt relationship
- Xie Rong who Chen is very attracted to, but who has made the ‘choice’ to work as a prostitute,
- the underlying suggestion that the Party itself is corrupt
- an alternative interpretation might be that Chen remains an incorruptible romantic and an ‘honest policeman’
- Yu and Peiquin’s marriage which survives their work at the Xishuang Garden.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the beautiful opening setting of Baili which is ‘unpolluted’ and has ‘golden sun’ but is corrupted for Gao and Liu by the discovery of the body
- the oxymoronic depiction of Guan’s dead body which is both ‘still good-looking’ but also ‘ghastly white’
- the symbolic use of the new ‘long bamboo stick’ which Gao uses to fish out the dead body and subsequently ‘snaps in two’ as it would now ‘bring bad luck’
- the Russian hostesses at Moscow Suburb who are described only by their physical beauty but are considered as examples of ‘Western bourgeois decadence’
- the inclusion of Chen’s poem ‘*Night Talk*’
- the inclusion of Chinese Socialist language in the article from the People’s Daily about Wu’s case,
- the ending which focuses on the beauty of everyday Chinese life.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the subjects of Xiaolong's novel
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction methods, any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which are grounded in the question and which relate to the novel as a whole.

0 9

Kate Atkinson: *When Will There Be Good News?*

‘Jackson had never been one to say no, either to goddesses or to requests for help.’

How far do you agree that Jackson Brodie is presented as a force for justice in *When Will There Be Good News?*

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but as ‘significance’ relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied *When Will There Be Good News?* through the lens of **crime and mystery** writing, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Jackson’s teaming up with Reggie to find Joanna Hunter
- Jackson’s bravery and willingness to help Reggie despite his injuries
- Jackson’s working outside of the law so as to protect Joanna from possible criminal charges which could be considered as a force for justice, or as working against it
- an alternative argument might be that Jackson lets Billy go free at Reggie’s request and ‘didn’t seem to care’ about police procedure
- the relationship between Jackson and Louise and Jackson’s semi-betrayal of her trust
- that Jackson works outside of and sometimes at odds with traditional institutions tasked with delivering justice.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Atkinson’s consistent positioning of Jackson on the side of the ethical and good
- the irony of Jackson, who is twice Joanna’s rescuer being mistaken for Andrew Decker by the police
- the chapters focalised by Jackson which allow the reader access to his belief that he is a crusader of justice
- candidates may comment on the fact that Jackson has an established heritage in the wider series where he is an established force for justice
- the ending which focuses on Jackson’s initial finding of Joanna
- Jackson’s characterisation as a maverick and the conflict between himself and Louise who represents the traditional sense of justice
- the authorial approval given to Jackson in the quotation in the title and throughout the narrative.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument, here related to the subjects of Atkinson's novel
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid discussion of prose fiction methods, any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of contexts of production and reception which are grounded in the question and which relate to the novel as a whole.

GET HELP AND SUPPORT

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You can contact the English subject team directly at:

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